

Drawings in, ETABS model out

Where the drawing-ingestion tool stands on 15 September 2026, measured against our own archive — and what the next two weeks are for.

253 of 296 sets build slabs on 41% of storeys

WHAT I'M BUILDING, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

A tool that reads our own structural drawing sets — the PDF stick files we already issue — and produces an ETABS model: columns, walls, slabs, grid lines and storeys, with no Revit and no re-drawing. Today an engineer rebuilds that model by hand. When Andrea first saw the output: *"if I have that, it's going to take me like no time to rebuild it."* The long-term value is the reissue workflow — the architect sends an update, the tool says what changed. No AEC firm I know of has this; the commercial CSiXRevit route never worked for us, and this one is made of our own drafting conventions.

WHERE IT STANDS – MEASURED, NOT ESTIMATED

ARCHIVE

253 of 296 build

Every current stick file in our archive runs through the tool on every change, in under an hour. 253 (85%) produce a model from the PDF alone; the 43 that don't say why in a ledger — 17 are copies of another job's file, 17 have no plan the reader can type, 8 name no storey.

ACCURACY

59% of columns within 100 mm

Against the engineers' own ETABS models on 51 jobs — and most of those models are older than the drawings, so the true figure is higher. The bigger gap is slabs: present on 41% of storeys.

RIGOUR

Nothing lives in anyone's head

Every rule the reader applies is code with a test, or a row in our standards database (86 rows). Adversarially audited four times by an independent AI reviewer; the last audit's eleven findings were fixed the same day.

WHAT "USABLE" MEANS, IN THE ENGINEERS' OWN WORDS

The bar

"As long as I have the vertical and overall the shape of the slab, it's good enough for me to start." — verticals and a slab outline on every storey; one model per building; loads, sections and diaphragms stay with the engineer. We have the verticals everywhere; slab outlines on 41% of storeys — that gap is the next two weeks.

What their answers already settled

Footings aren't modelled; basement and retaining walls are; beams aren't (headers are); each level shown once; one file per building — each now a rule the tool obeys; nothing is re-asked.

NEXT TWO WEEKS

1. A slab outline on every storey (the engineers' bar).
2. Footings are not columns; part plans never duplicate the overall plan — both from the engineers' recorded answers.
3. The remaining 26 sets that could build and don't, each named by its cause.

THEN

Models for three live jobs — one per building, as the engineers asked — published to the job folders for review. Their feedback becomes rules, as Andrea's already has. The ask at that point: an hour of each engineer's time with their model open.

WHY IT MATTERS

A proprietary capability nobody else in our market has.

It removes the typing, not the engineering — and every reissue becomes a diff instead of a rebuild. No vendor can build it, because it is made of our conventions.